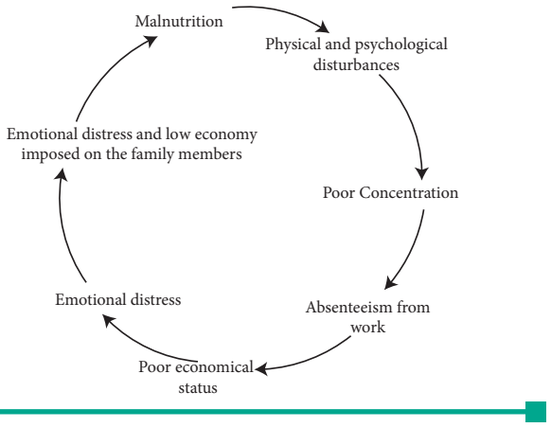
vitamin C is lost during cooking 40 mg of vitamin C per day is recommended.

Nutritional Problems for an Adult

- Osteoporosis
- Anemia
- Chronic Disease
- Diabetes Mellitus
- Underweight
- Coronary Heart Disease (CHD)
- Poor Nutritional Status

Many of the health problems of older adults are not only due to general aging but also due to states of malnutrition.



▲ Fig. 6.4 Malnutrition

6.7 NUTRITIONAL REQUIREMENTS OF PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN

Nutrition requirements increase tremendously during pregnancy and lactation owing to the physiological changes.

DO YOU KNOW?

Primipara – A woman having her first child

Wholesome nourishment before pregnancy has a greater impact on the long term health on the mother and foetus. A well nourished foetus enters life with good physical and mental health.

Physiological Changes in Pregnancy

Foetal development is accompanied by many physiological, biochemical and hormonal changes which influence the nutrient needs and the efficiency with which the body utilizes them. The changes include

i. Increased basal metabolic rate (BMR)

Due to foetal growth the BMR increases.

ii. Gastro intestinal changes

Gastro intestinal motility diminishes which may result in constipation.

iii. Hormonal changes

During pregnancy there is increased secretion of the following hormones: i) Aldosterone ii) Progesterone iii) Thyroxin iv) Parathormone.

iv. Changes in body fluid

The blood volume expands by 50 percent and this increased amount of blood is required to carry nutrients to the foetus and remove metabolic wastes from the foetus.

v. Altered renal function

Increased blood volume and increased production of waste products like creatinine, urea and other wastes due to foetal and maternal metabolism produces a high glomerular filtration rate (GFR).

vi. Weight Gain during Pregnancy

Less than half of total weight gain resides in the foetus, placenta and amniotic fluid. Women with desirable body weight is 12.5 kg ranging between 11-13 kg.

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